

California STEM Innovators (CSI)

Biotechnology Workshop: From DNA to Discovery

PARTICIPANT WAIVER, RELEASE OF LIABILITY, ASSUMPTION OF RISK, MEDICAL AUTHORIZATION & MEDIA CONSENT

This form must be completed and signed by a parent or legal guardian of any participant under 18 years of age. Please read this entire document carefully before signing. This is a legal document that affects your rights and the rights of your child.

1. Event Information

Event: CSI Biotechnology Workshop — From DNA to Discovery

Organizer: California STEM Innovators (CSI), a student-led STEM nonprofit organization

Date: September 19, 2026, 3:00 PM PDT

Location: Union City Library, Union City, CA

2. Participant & Parent/Guardian Information

Participant (Child) Full Name:	Date of Birth:
Parent/Guardian Full Name:	Relationship to Participant:
Parent/Guardian Phone:	Parent/Guardian Email:
Emergency Contact Name (if different):	Emergency Contact Phone:
Known Allergies or Medical Conditions CSI Should Be Aware Of:	

3. Description of Activities

The Workshop includes hands-on science activities designed for middle and high school students, including but not limited to:

- DNA extraction from strawberries using household reagents (dish soap, salt, water) and isopropyl alcohol.
- A bacterial transformation lab ("True Blue," provided by miniPCR) using a non-pathogenic, lab-safe (BSL-1) strain of E. coli, involving heat-shock procedures and plating on agar.
- Micropipetting practice, a gel electrophoresis demonstration, and related instructional activities.
- General group participation, movement around the workshop space, and use of shared tables, supplies, and equipment.

4. Acknowledgment of Risks

I understand that, although CSI takes reasonable precautions to reduce risk, participation in hands-on science activities involves inherent risks, hazards, and dangers that cannot be completely eliminated regardless of the care taken. These include, but are not limited to:

- Exposure to isopropyl alcohol and other laboratory reagents, which may cause skin, eye, or respiratory irritation, and which is flammable.

- Minor cuts, pinches, or punctures from lab tools, toothpicks, glassware, or plastic labware.
- Allergic reactions to strawberries, latex, or other materials used in the workshop.
- Exposure to biological materials, including non-pathogenic laboratory bacteria, with a small risk of contamination if safety procedures are not followed.
- Slips, trips, or falls in the workshop space.
- Choking or ingestion hazards from small materials (e.g., toothpicks, pipette tips), particularly relevant for younger participants.
- Risks associated with the Union City Library premises generally, which are outside CSI's control.

I understand this list is not exhaustive and that other risks, known or unknown, anticipated or unanticipated, may exist.

5. Assumption of Risk

I understand that participation in the Workshop is entirely voluntary. I knowingly and freely assume all such risks, both known and unknown, on behalf of myself and the participant named above, even if arising from the negligence of the Released Parties (defined below), and assume full responsibility for the participant's participation.

6. Release and Waiver of Liability

In consideration of being permitted to participate in the Workshop, I, for myself, the participant named above, our heirs, and personal representatives, do hereby release, waive, discharge, and covenant not to sue California STEM Innovators (CSI), its officers, directors, student organizers, volunteers, mentors, sponsors (including miniPCR), and the Union City Library and its staff (collectively, the "Released Parties"), from any and all liability, claims, demands, actions, or causes of action whatsoever arising out of or related to any loss, damage, or injury, including death, that may be sustained by the participant, or to any property belonging to the participant, while participating in the Workshop, or while on the premises where the Workshop is being conducted, to the fullest extent permitted by California law.

This release does not apply to injury, loss, or damage caused by the Released Parties' gross negligence, willful misconduct, or intentional acts, which cannot be waived under California law.

7. Indemnification

To the fullest extent permitted by law, I agree to indemnify and hold harmless the Released Parties from any loss, liability, damage, or costs, including court costs and attorney fees, that any Released Party may incur due to the participant's presence or participation in the Workshop, whether caused by the negligence of the Released Parties or otherwise.

8. Medical Treatment Authorization

In the event of an injury or medical emergency during the Workshop, I authorize CSI staff and volunteers to secure any necessary emergency medical treatment for the participant, including transportation by emergency medical services, if a parent or guardian cannot be immediately reached. I understand that I am responsible for all costs associated with such treatment.

9. Photo, Video & Media Consent

I grant CSI permission to photograph and/or video record the participant during the Workshop and to use these images or recordings for CSI's educational, promotional, and archival purposes, including on its website and social media, without compensation. I may notify CSI in writing before the event if I do not wish the participant to be photographed or recorded.

10. Rules of Conduct

I understand that the participant is expected to follow all written and verbal safety instructions given by CSI facilitators. CSI reserves the right to remove any participant from the Workshop, without refund, for failure to follow safety instructions or for

conduct that endangers themselves or others. Parents/guardians remain responsible for supervision arrangements outside of the specific activity instruction provided by CSI facilitators.

11. Severability & Governing Law

If any portion of this agreement is held to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions will continue in full force and effect. This agreement is governed by the laws of the State of California.

I HAVE READ THIS WAIVER, RELEASE OF LIABILITY, ASSUMPTION OF RISK, MEDICAL AUTHORIZATION, AND MEDIA CONSENT FORM. I UNDERSTAND ITS TERMS, UNDERSTAND THAT I HAVE GIVEN UP SUBSTANTIAL LEGAL RIGHTS BY SIGNING IT, INCLUDING THE RIGHT TO SUE, AND SIGN IT FREELY AND VOLUNTARILY ON BEHALF OF MYSELF AND THE PARTICIPANT NAMED ABOVE, WITHOUT ANY INDUCEMENT.

Parent/Guardian Signature

Date

Printed Name